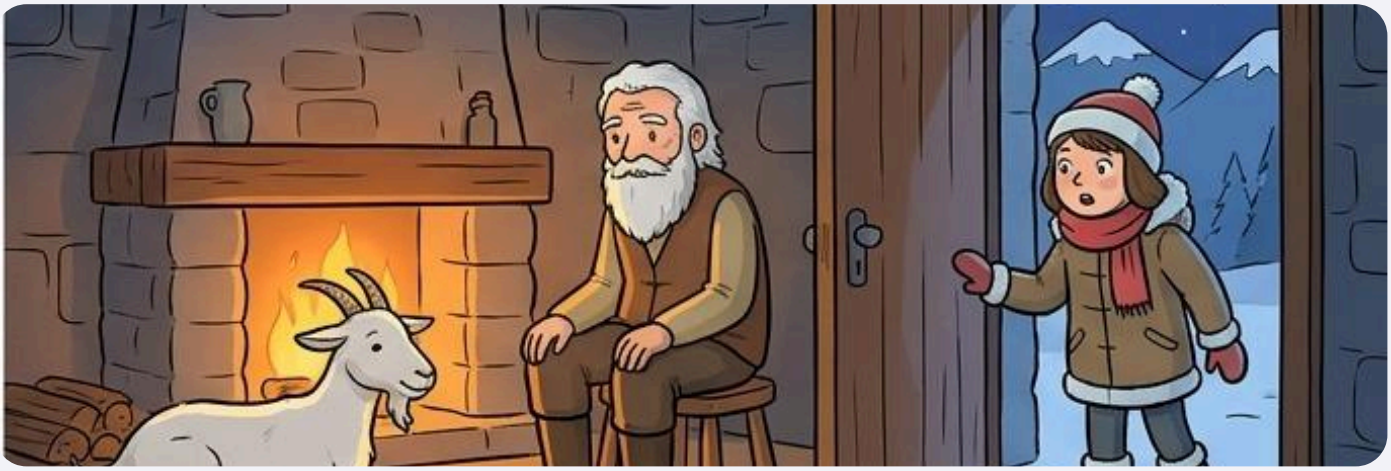
Ghosts, Fog and Storms

Day 1 · Reading (1 of 2)

What to do: Read it aloud, one paragraph each. Stop at every blue word: can anybody explain it?

Vocabulary topic: Ghosts and surviving bad weather
20 new words (in blue) · EEW 1, Unit 6 · read about ghost stories and bad weather and talk about how to stay safe



easy parts harder parts (most new words are here)

Every country has ghost stories. In Britain there are old castles with ghost knights. In Japan there are ghosts in old water wells. In Central Asia, grandmothers tell stories about a white woman who walks near rivers at night. People love these stories, because a little **fright** is exciting when you are safe at home.

Why do people believe in **ghosts**? Scientists give several reasons. The first **cause** is simple: the brain. In the dark we see and hear less, so the brain tries to fill the empty space. A shadow becomes a person, and the wind becomes a **voice**. When people are afraid, they see more danger. When they are **upset**, the mind can even create the **face** of a **dead** person. This does not mean that the person is crazy: it is a normal reaction of the brain.

Many ghost stories are about the **weather**: a dark night, strong wind, cold rain, thick fog. Fog is the best friend of every ghost. You can only see a few meters, and every tree looks like a person.

But bad weather is not only a good story. It is a real danger, and every year people have to **survive** in it. A **community** of mountain people knows the rules very well. They say: when the storm comes, do not try to **escape** alone. Make a **choice** and stay in a safe place, because the **distance** to a village in the snow is much longer than you think. In a group, every **individual** has an **advantage**: somebody can look for the way, somebody can keep the fire and somebody can **follow** the map. If the snow is too thick, do not follow the wind: stay still and wait for the morning.

You may think that a **pet** is only for fun. But in snow and rain, a dog can be a great helper. Dogs can find a person under the snow because of their strong noses, and they can **reach** places that people cannot.

Ghosts, Fog and Storms

Day 1 · Reading (2 of 2)

What to do: After reading: which paragraphs were easy, which were hard? Which blue words did you know already?

Old people are often called **wise**, because they remember many storms. In many villages, the grandfather knows when the snow comes: he looks at the sky, at the animals and at the wind. This knowledge helps the whole village to **return** home safely and to prepare food and fire before the cold. Today we have phones and weather apps, but the old way is still good: look, listen and think before you go.

Here is a short story from your book, Unit 6. A kind woman lived by a river. After her death she became a ghost, and every night she came back to her village to help the children. The children were afraid of her scary voice, but in the end she saved them from the water. Read it: this ghost is friendlier than scary.

A fun fact about old houses: they make a lot of noise at night. The wood gets cold and cracks, the pipes knock and the doors move in the wind. Many “ghosts” are just a house. Next time you hear a noise at night, count to ten and listen: it is probably the house.

In many countries, a large number of people say they believe in ghosts. Others say they do not believe, but they never walk through a cemetery at night. Maybe the truth is in the middle: we do not believe in ghosts, but we like to feel a little afraid.

If you ever get lost in the snow, remember four rules: stop, think, stay warm and make yourself easy to see. Wear bright colors, make a fire if it is safe, and use a whistle: a whistle is heard farther than a voice. And do not walk in a circle: when people are tired, they walk in big circles without knowing it.

What is your advice for a dark and stormy night? Stay warm, stay together, drink something hot and tell a good ghost story. It is the best way to forget the storm outside.

The 20 words

Day 1 · Vocabulary table · Topic: Ghosts and surviving bad weather

What to do: Book: 4000 EEW 1, Unit 6, pages 38–41. Copy the words you do not know into the copybook.

Word	Meaning	По-русски	Example
advantage n.	something good that helps you	преимущество	Speaking English is a big advantage.
cause v./n.	the reason why something happens	вызывать; причина	Too much sugar causes problems.
choice n.	a decision between two or more things	выбор	You have a choice: tea or juice.
community n.	the people who live in one place	сообщество, община	Our community cleaned the park.
dead adj.	not alive any more	мёртвый	The flowers are dead: nobody watered them.
distance n.	how far it is between two places	расстояние	The distance to school is 2 km.
escape v.	get away from a place or danger	убегать, сбегать	The bird escaped from its cage.
face n./v.	the front of the head; to meet a problem	лицо; смотреть в лицо	She has a friendly face.
follow v.	go after someone or something	следовать, идти за	The ducklings follow their mother.
fright n.	a sudden strong fear	испуг	The loud noise gave me a fright.
ghost n.	the spirit of a dead person	призрак	Do you believe in ghosts?
individual n./adj.	one single person	человек, личность; отдельный	Every individual is different.
pet n.	an animal you keep at home	домашнее животное	My pet is a cat.
reach v.	get to a place; touch something far away	доставать; достигать	I can't reach the top shelf.
return v.	come or go back	возвращаться	We returned home at 9.
survive v.	stay alive in a dangerous situation	выживать	Camels survive without water for days.
upset adj.	unhappy and worried	расстроенный	She was upset because she lost her phone.
voice n.	the sound you make when you speak	голос	He has a beautiful voice.
weather n.	rain, sun, wind and temperature	погода	The weather was terrible yesterday.
wise adj.	having a lot of knowledge and good ideas	мудрый	My grandpa is a wise man.

More on the topic

Day 1 · Topic: Ghosts and surviving bad weather · more words

What to do: Choose 5 collocations to learn. Use the reserve words when a student already knows the main ones.

Collocations: words that go together

a ghost story	история о привидениях
give someone a fright	напугать кого-то
a scary voice	страшный голос
bad weather	плохая погода
survive a storm	пережить бурю
make a choice	сделать выбор
the local community	местное сообщество
a long distance	большое расстояние
follow the path	идти по тропе
reach the top	добраться до вершины
return home	вернуться домой
an upset child	расстроенный ребёнок

Phrasal verbs

come back	вернуться	The ghost came back every night.
go away	уйти, уезжать	Go away! You scare me.
keep out	не входить	Keep out! Dangerous place.
get through	пережить, пройти через	We got through the storm together.
turn back	повернуть назад	The snow was too deep, so we turned back.
wait for	ждать	Wait for the morning.

Reserve words: for students who know the 20 already, or if you prefer another word

fog	туман	**castle**	замок
storm	буря	**spirit**	дух
thunder	гром	**brave**	храбрый
lightning	молния	**rescue**	спасать
shadow	тень	**shelter**	укрытие

What to read next · 4000 Essential English Words

This week: **Book 1, Unit 6, "The Friendly Ghost"**, pages 38–43. Next: **Unit 7, "The Best Prince"**, pages 44–49. About a storm and an animal: **Unit 5, "The Jackal and the Sun Child"**, pages 32–37.